

ENGLISH, POWER, ACCESS

Conspiracies About English

POLICY WAS OFTEN PUBLIC

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Test every claim carefully

RECORD

Which document exists?

Find the original.

SCOPE

Where did it apply?

Avoid global leaps.

MECHANISM

How would it work?

Name each pathway.

ALTERNATIVES

What else explains it?

Compare ordinary causes.

Suspicion starts investigation.

Claim: Empire used policy

SUPPORTED

1835

Macaulay

English higher study.

1854

Wood's Despatch

English plus vernaculars.

1940

British Council

Language supported influence.

These records are public.

Claim: One hidden masterplan

UNPROVEN

POLICIES

Policies differed.

PERIODS

Periods changed.

PLACES

Local actors adapted.

RECORDS

No master record
appears.

Many actions $\neq$ one plot.

Missing proof stays missing.

Claim: Institutions promote English

SUPPORTED

BRITISH COUNCIL

Public mission

Language builds
connections.

AVIATION

Safety standard

English proficiency
matters.

INFLUENCE

Stated benefit

Reputation supports
growth.

Promotion is not secret.

Public influence still matters.

Claim: Simplicity caused dominance

UNPROVEN

CLAIM

“English is easiest.”

No decisive evidence.

BETTER EXPLANATION

Power built networks.

Networks rewarded learning.

History sustained reach.

Ease never proves dominance.

Claim: English erased rivals

OVERSTATED

PRESSURE

Language pressure is real.

ACCESS

Access remains unequal.

UNITED NATIONS

Six official languages.

EUROPEAN UNION

Twenty-four official languages.

Harm needs specific evidence.

Sources and verdicts

Macaulay and Wood

Documented policy

British Council, ICAO

Public promotion

Crystal and Ricento

Power explanations

UNESCO, UN, EU

Claim testing

SUPPORTED

OVERSTATED

UNPROVEN

NEXT: Orwell and political language